RESEARCH ETHICS OFFICE

APPLICATION FOR RESEARCH ETHICS REVIEW

Application No.: _____

A. Preliminaries

Types of Ethics Review Applied for:	☐ Human Use ☐ Animal Welfare ☐ Plant Use ☐ Microbiological/Biotechnological Use ☐ Engineering ☑ Information Technology Use ☐ Food Technology Use
Project/Study Title :	CredentiaTAU: A Web-based Academic Record Archiving System
Project/Study Duration	
Planned Start Date	June 2026
Planned End Date	December 2026

B. Administrative Information

Name of the Principal Applicant	Rhiel A. Guillermo
Name of Research Members *(if there is any)*	Oliver M. Fiesta John Benedict A. Reyes Jayan Carlo M. Caldona
Office/University/Department	Department of Computer Studies, College of Engineering and Technology
Contact Email Address	rhielg1@gmail.com
Contact Telephone Number	09934332588
Email Address of Adviser	mrmpablo@tau.edu.ph
Source of funding (if there is any)	
Has the project/study undergone research ethics review?	☐ **YES** ☑ **NO**
If yes, indicate where and status of review	

C. Project/Study Description

C.1 Executive Summary (Maximum of 300 words)

The management of student records has become progressively difficult for many educational institutions due to the ongoing expansion of student data and the reliance on manual, paper-based filing systems. Conventional record management often leads to time consuming document retrieval, an increased risk of record loss or destruction, and restricted access to essential academic material. These problems underscore the necessity for a more effective and systematic method of managing academic records.

This study suggests the creation of CredentiaTAU: Web-based Academic Record Archiving System for the Admission and Registration Services at Tarlac Agricultural University to resolve these challenges. The system aims to digitize and systematize student records into a single digital repository to enhance record storage and retrieval. Authorized personnel will utilize the web-based application to store, manage, and

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access academic records securely. The technology is anticipated to enhance efficiency, strengthen document security, and enable superior preservation of institutional data.

C.2 Study Design

- The main objective of the study is to design and develop a web-based academic archiving system (E-Archive) that digitizes, organizes, and securely stores academic records for faster, safer, and more efficient retrieval for the Admission and Registration Services of Tarlac Agricultural University.
- The study addresses the issue of manual record management, which frequently cause to slow document retrieval, potential record loss or destruction, and ineffective storage of essential academic records. This study aims to enhance record management, document security, and accessibility by creating a centralized digital archiving system.
- Data will be collected through a literature review, interviews with Admission and Registration Services staff, questionnaires, and observation to determine system requirements. The developed system will be evaluated using a Likert-scale questionnaire, with the Weighted Mean assessing functionality and usability. Unit and security testing will also be conducted to ensure effective and secure system performance, supporting the study's goal of improving record management, document security, and accessibility.
- This study serves as a pilot implementation at Tarlac Agricultural University to enhance the record management functions of the Admission and Registration Services. The study concentrates on the design, development, testing, and assessment of the proposed system and is independent of any broader research initiative.

C.3 Detailed Description of the Methodology

- The study will be conducted at the Admission and Registration Service of Tarlac Agricultural University, located in Malacampa, Camiling, Tarlac, Philippines, during the Academic Year 2025 - 2026.
- The study's evaluators comprised all staff from the Admission and Registration Services. The office served as the research site because it is the responsible for managing, storing, and retrieving student records within the university.

Attachments to this Application

Please tick the box if the following documents are attached to this application:

☑	Full copy of the research proposal/thesis outline including instruments to be used (e.g. survey, questionnaire, interview guide, interview schedule, and educational tests)
☑	Accomplished Research Ethics Category Form

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☑	Curriculum Vitae (include past research activities i.e. publication, paper presentation, previous studies)
☑	Informed Consent Form, if applicable (see the General Guidelines for the format)
☐	If under Human Use, comply the following documents: - Certificate of Instrument Validation (see the General Guidelines for the format) - Guardian or Parental consent to the participants/human subjects who have not attained the legal age for consent or are considered competent to provide consent (if applicable)

Declaration

I certify that I have read and understood the Ethical Guidelines for Responsible Conduct of Research of the Tarlac Agricultural University and hereby abide by the ethical principles described in the research ethics checklist. Further, I will submit a copy of my final report of the proposed study to the TAU-Research Ethics Review Committee. I will not commence with data collection until after I receive an ethics review approval from the University Research Ethics Review Committee and ethics clearance certificate from the Department of Research and Development.

Rhiel A. Guillermo Name and Signature of the Principal Applicant	03-24-2026 Date

Adviser's Approval

FOR GRADUATE AND UNDERGRADUATE TAU STUDENTS ONLY

I confirm that the student(s) are capable of undertaking this research in a safe and ethical manner.

Maria Regina M. Pablo, MSIT Adviser's Name	Signature	3/24/2026 Date